

December 3, 1994 is a day that has earned a permanent spot in the history of gaming. That was the day Sony released the PlayStation. Sony had worked with Nintendo to develop a CD add-on for the SNES. When the deal fell through, Sony decided to use all their development work to come out with their own console. It quickly went on to become the best selling product in the company's history. With millions of top-quality games available, it quickly became a firm favourite with gamers.

In 2000, the PS was re-released as the PSOne, in a smaller casing. For many, the release of the PlayStation was the defining moment of their generation—the PlayStation generation. Because of its astounding popularity, the PlayStation almost single-handedly shaped the gaming industry as we know it today—a multi-billion dollar industry which earns more in a year than Hollywood does!

By now, cartridges had been well and truly replaced. CDs became the standard media for games, chiefly because they could store much more data, and were cheaper to mass-produce. Sega decided the time was right to come out with a new CD-based console, little knowing it would turn out to be their last ever. The Dreamcast was released on the odd date of 9/9/99. It was the very first 128-bit system and the first one to support online gaming as well. Each Dreamcast came with a built in 56K modem, with the ability to add a faster modem if required, making it relatively future-proof.

Over 500,000 units of Dreamcast were sold in the first two weeks. However, Sony soon launched PlayStation 2. Although it didn't feature online gaming, it had the ability to play DVDs—a developing market at the time. PS2 diverted the attention from Dreamcast. The launch of the Xbox and the Nintendo GameCube was the final nail in Sega's coffin. Sega didn't have the financial power to fight the likes of Sony and Microsoft. In January 2001, Dreamcast was officially discontinued, and Sega decided to focus on making games rather than consoles.